Revision XVIII — Independent audit and critical editorial supplement

Ibn ʿAjība, The Immense Ocean, Volume I: preface through Q4:176.

Status: scholarly translation and reference edition, pre-publication critical proof. Not an established critical Arabic edition.

This supplement is appended to the complete 1,306-page Revision XVI master. No authorial English passage is retranslated, no Cairo Arabic copytext is silently emended, and the inherited text, Cairo footnotes, translator annotations, registers, and indexes are preserved. Revision XVIII supplies a fresh structural audit, verifiable source-based refinements, a 37-case editorial docket, and review/printing instructions.

1. Technical integrity and translation coverage

- 389 passage headings, including introductions and authorial preface; 384 headings with explicit Qurʾānic verse ranges.
- The ranges cover all **669** verses from al-Fātiḥa through al-Nisāʾ, with no omission, overlap or extraneous verse label. This tests heading ranges, not the faithfulness of every translated clause.
- The attached production PDF has **1,306** pages, 2,034 outline entries and **5,429** hyperlinks, including **5,198** internal links. No out-of-range internal page targets were found. Link target validity does not prove that each link points to the intended annotation.
- XVI's historical validation ledger reports 3,320 checks passed, 241 Cairo notes, 209 current translator-note views and 3,273 quotation/Qurʾānic census rows located. Underlying XVI source-data JSON and independent validation scripts were not supplied; those historical checks were not represented as newly re-run.
- The supplied PDF and editable files differ in raw hashes from the original XVI ledger. The new audit records SHA-256 hashes for the bytes actually present and tests them afresh.

2. Editorial policy and witness distinctions

The Cairo edition is the sole directly established Baḥr copytext for the inherited Volume I. Textual parallels from other works clarify interpretation or the history of quotations; they do not themselves establish Ibn ʿAjība's original letters. An online transcription labelled as Cairo, even when it displays different vowel marks, is not automatically an independent witness. Separate printed editions are bibliographically real, but their manuscript base must be documented from the edition itself before assigning them witness status in a stemma.

Decisions: retain Cairo's Arabic wherever the evidence is incomplete; retain carefully bracketed or qualified English; cite specific earlier works when actually checked; label editorial claims as such; avoid upgrading a literary parallel into hadith authentication or a conjectural emendation.

3. Direct source checks newly consolidated

XVIII-A01 · Cairo I:111 · musāwara

Nashwān al-Ḥimyarī, Shams al-ʿulūm, entry al-musāwara, states المساورة: المواثبة. This confirms an image of sudden springing/assailing, not a technical sense of "intimate approach." Existing Cairo musāwara and cautious English stay.

Source: https://almougem.com/search.php?mdatabase=lmougem&query=%D8%B3%D9%88%D8%B1

XVIII-A02 · Cairo I:312 · the position and chronology of Q2:281

Al-Qurṭubī explicitly transmits the command to place this passage at the boundary after the first 280 verses, while recording competing last-revelation accounts. Ibn Ḥajar in Fatḥ al-bārī reconciles "verse of usury" and Q2:281 through their connected placement, observes the distinct Q4:176 report, and records nine nights, seven nights and twenty-one days. The report of an angelic instruction is a transmitted claim; neither work by itself supplies authentication of the whole route. Retain the existing XVI translation, "Place it after the first two hundred and eighty verses."

Source: https://ablibrary.net/book_content/b/2612/153

XVIII-A03 · Cairo I:451 · al-kull in the remembrance poem

The XVI dossier reports Cairo printed vocalization al-kullu (nominative). A publicly displayed Cairo-labelled Quranpedia text at Q3:191–194 instead gives وَوَاصَلَ الْكُلَّ with the accusative; another electronic text leaves the word unvowelled. These are not independent manuscripts and can represent later editorial vocalization. The additional divergence reopens grammatical analysis but licenses NO change to the Arabic consonants or English without direct print-level comparison. At Q7:206 Ibn ʿAjība places the same poem within five degrees of remembrance; Ibn ʿAbbād supplies a preceding literary parallel. Neither settles identity or the unique grammatical subject.

Source: https://quranpedia.net/surah/1/3/book/206

XVIII-A04 · Cairo I:569 · fairness among wives

The Cairo electronic text explicitly reads فلا يجب العدل في البيت فقط. In his Q4:129 exposition, al-Ṭabarī distinguishes involuntary equality of love from enforceable rights to equitable turns (qasm), maintenance (nafaqa), and good treatment (ʿishra bi-l-maʿrūf). Thus the difficult

clause cannot be read as a blanket exemption from obligatory fairness. Retain the printed text, record possible semantic use of bayt as overnight stay, and DO NOT replace it with al-mabīt or al-ḥubb without a textual witness.

Source: https://quran.ksu.edu.sa/tafseer/tabary/sura4-aya129.html

XVIII-A05 · Beirut/Rāwī edition — bibliographic control

Catalogues document an eight-volume Beirut edition associated with ʿUmar Aḥmad al-Rāwī and ʿAbd al-Salām al-ʿImrānī al-Khālidī (initial 1423/2002 printing; later catalogued edition/impression dates). That proves a separate published edition exists, NOT that its textual base or readings are independent of Ruslān. No page from that actual printing was obtained for a verifiable word-for-word collation during this audit. Record as a print witness requiring examination, rather than claiming collation.

Source: https://library.ecssr.ae/cgi-bin/koha/opac-detail.pl?biblionumber=189396

XVIII-A06 · Cairo editorial variants policy

Ruslān's introduction says that he established the text primarily from a Tuhāmī exemplar and generally did not burden the printed notes with minor differences in the other copies. A lack of a variant in his apparatus therefore is NOT evidence that the copies agree. With no additional manuscript images, a stemma, authorial revision sequence, full variant collation, or secure emendation remains impossible.

Source: https://arabic-keyboard.info/books/ar/read-book/%D8%A7%D9%84%D8%A8%D8%AD%D8%B1-%D8%A7%D9%84%D9%85%D8%AF%D9%8A%D8%AF-%D9%81%D9%8A-%D8%AA%D9%81%D8%B3%D9%8A%D8%B1-%D8%A7%D9%84%D9%82%D8%B1%D8%A2%D9%86-%D8%A7%D9%84%D9%85%D8%AC%D9%8A%D8%AF

4. Witness, edition and source provenance table

Role	Witness / printed source	Evidential reach
Cairo printed copytext	Ruslān, Cairo, 1419/1999, I:49–601	Copytext; apparatus supplied with master; variants in lesser witnesses selectively omitted
Beirut printing	ʿUmar Aḥmad al-Rāwī, Dār al-Kutub al-ʿIlmiyya (1423/2002; later catalogued reprints)	Bibliographic existence corroborated; actual printed pages and prefatory manuscript identification NOT collated
Beirut-derived digital listing	Ketabonline Quranweb description	Identifies al-Rāwī edition, but reading pages could not be independently inspected; NOT an attested textual variant
	Quranpedia Cairo/Ruslān data	Usable for locating excerpts; NOT an independent textual witness

Role	Witness / printed source	Evidential reach
Cairo-derived digital transcription		
Source: Shams al-ʿulūm	Nashwān al-Ḥimyarī, root s-w-r	Musāwara glossed muwāthaba
Source: Ibn Ḥajar	Fatḥ al-bārī, commentary on al-Bukhārī Q2:281 chapter	Explicit reconciliation of last-revelation reports, 7/9/21-day uncertainty
Source: al-Qurṭubī	Al-Jāmiʿ li-aḥkām al-Qurʾān, Q2:281	Gabriel placement reported; variant intervals and attributions
Source: al-Ṭabarī	Jāmiʿ al-bayān, Q4:129	Separates unenforceable equality of inward affection from enforceable turn-taking, maintenance, good treatment
Arabic presentation: Cairo I:451	Quranpedia display of Āl ʿImrān	Displays al-kulla in accusative in one Cairo-labelled electronic text; requires print-image verification
Arabic presentation: Cairo I:451	Ahl al-Bayt digital reading of Ruslān	Print-page transcription does not independently attest a distinct manuscript reading
Internal authorial parallel	Ibn ʿAjība, al-Baḥr, Q7:206	Poem recurs in five degrees of remembrance; electronic pagination differs
Earlier poem parallel	Ibn ʿAbbād, Ghayth al-mawāhib, pp. 73–74	Three-line poem in context of vanishing individual awareness in dhikr
Cairo Q4:129 display	Quranpedia Ibn ʿAjība text	Shows exactly فلا يجب العدل في البيت فقط; same Cairo-derived text, not variant

5. Complete open-question docket — 37 identified loci

The following dockets derive from the existing XVI textual appendix. “Explained” does **not** mean “manuscript variant verified.” Precise wording, provenance and source attribution remain open wherever indicated. Entries are given in Cairo-page order, with the two supplementary source problems at the end.

01. Cairo I:79 — Separating pronoun term

Passage: 2:11–12 · Corruption disguised as reform (English p. 59). **Finding:** Grammatical construction controlled; printed lettering still suspect. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The nominal clause ألا إنهم هم المفسدون contains no verbal predicate to which hum could refer as “the pronoun of the verb.” Al-Bayḍāwī and al-Nasafī explicitly include the separating pronoun in their parallel lists of emphatic devices, and al-

Qurṭubī also records that grammatical analysis. “Separating pronoun” therefore expresses the relevant construction. Cairo’s الفعل differs from the expected الفصل; the precise authorial letters and the origin of that difference remain unestablished.

02. Cairo I:110 — The preposition before penetration to the lights

Passage: 2:57 · Manna, quails and the two gardens of the spirit (English p. 115). **Finding:** Contextual sense clarified; preposition unresolved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The following clauses contrast witnessing the lights with remaining veiled by created effects. Ibn ʿAjība’s Īqāẓ al-himam, p. 230, likewise describes the clouds of effects clearing so that light shines and the heart becomes absent from forms. The connection of ilā, “to,” with the negative clause فلم تحجب … إلى نفوذ remains difficult. A temporal endpoint conflicts with the continuation, while ʿan, “from,” would be a conjectural replacement. The contextual meaning is clearer than the exact syntax.

03. Cairo I:111 — Musāwara in a list of intimate encounters

Passage: 2:58–59 · Entering through humility (English p. 118). **Finding:** Lexical range verified; technical nuance not fixed. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Both Cairo I:111 and Īqāẓ al-himam, p. 384, read musāwara. The latter places it among figurative expressions for spiritual perception and inward tasting but does not define it individually. Lisān al-ʿArab gives assailing or springing at someone as the Form III meaning. A forceful or overwhelming spiritual encounter is a possible contextual interpretation; “intimate drawing near” is not an established lexical equivalent. Musārara and musāmara are different words. An exact authorial explanation of musāwara in this context remains lacking.

04. Cairo I:114 — Weariness versus being free or safe

Passage: 2:61 · Rejecting the allotted provision (English p. 123). **Finding:** Contextual conjecture; no independent local reading. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The opening describes weariness with honey and meat. In the ensuing moral generalization, وسئم, “grew weary,” would parallel dissatisfaction with one’s allotment, whereas Cairo’s وسلم, “was free or safe,” produces a different and contextually difficult sense. “Grew weary” is a contextual conjecture. An unattributed modern web quotation with وسئم does not establish an independent witness to Ibn ʿAjība’s wording.

05. Cairo I:138 — The negative conditional about preservation of faith

Passage: 2:94–95 · Longing for the meeting with God (English p. 165). **Finding:** Difficult condition; no corroborated alternative Baḥr reading. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The printed negative condition is followed by preservation of faith and then “otherwise he has perished.” Taken as ordinary consecutive conditional clauses, these statements conflict. The surrounding account makes antecedent divine care the exception to the heedless person’s danger. The printed al-ʿĀqiba parallel has the same difficulty, with dual pronouns referring to its preceding two classes. A manuscript facsimile of that earlier work omits the entire conditional and the following supplication; it supplies no alternative particle. The possibilities of omission, intrusive negation and anacoluthon remain unresolved.

06. Cairo I:157 — Wine-poem hemistich concerning indwelling

Passage: 2:116–117 · Origination without dependence and creation subsisting through God (English p. 201). **Finding:** Internal parallel confirms sense; order of words still disputed. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: At Cairo II:22, on Q5:17, Ibn ʿAjība quotes the line with the order فليس لها سوى في شكله حلت. There siwā denotes a hypothetical “other”; the feminine pronouns refer to the eternal wine, and the masculine suffix in shaklihi to that other. The preceding prose denies that a second entity exists in which the wine could dwell or with which it could unite. This internal parallel explains the meaning and pronouns. The different order at I:157 remains a question of textual transmission.

07. Cairo I:178 — Absence in the witnessing of vessels

Passage: 2:145–147 · Knowledge resisted and truth concealed (English p. 237). **Finding:** Vessel metaphor interpreted; fī retained. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The phrase addresses the gnostic and uses fī, “in,” with awānī, “vessels.” Miʿrāj al-tashawwuf defines sensible forms as vessels of inward meanings. Ibn ʿAjība’s discussions at Q6:103 and Q7:143 distinguish the vessels from the meanings witnessed through them; the latter describes absence from vessels through witnessing meanings. These parallels clarify the vocabulary without explaining the present construction, “absent in witnessing vessels.” Self-forgetful absorption is possible, but the sentence does not specify what the gnostic is absent from. An alternative preposition is not independently attested.

08. Cairo I:195 — The cause and origin of love in the Rāʾiyya commentary

Passage: 2:165–167 · Undivided love and the severing of false attachments (English p. 261). **Finding:** Literary source parallel located; Cairo wording retained. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Aḥmad b. Yūsuf al-Fāsī's commentary on the Rāʾiyya, p. 154, reads فسببه ومنشؤه, "its cause and origin." Lifting the veils is the cause of the second love, in contrast with the result or fruit of the first. Cairo instead prints فبسببه, "through or because of it." The source clarifies the causal relation; the authorial wording of the Baḥr and the origin of the discrepancy remain distinct textual questions.

09. Cairo I:237 — The omitted verb after kam

Passage: 2:211 · Changing the blessing after receiving it (English p. 335). **Finding:** Syntactic reconstruction supports translation, not precise letters. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Ibn ʿAṭiyya explicitly supplies the verb after initial kam and then gives the nominative alternative with a resumptive pronoun. This corresponds to Ibn ʿAjība's grammatical explanation. Cairo's آياتنا does not express the required supplied verb; the parallel آتينا does. "How many [We gave]—We gave them" represents that reconstruction. The exact authorial letters remain unestablished.

10. Cairo I:241 — The author explains injury reaching the seeker through others

Passage: 2:214 · Trial, trembling and the nearness of help (English p. 341). **Finding:** Agency clarified; source ending differs. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Īqāẓ al-himam expands the maxim to "through the hands of created people to you." The seeker receives the injury, other people are its intermediaries, and God is its ultimate agent in the author's argument. Cairo's ending, "repose in nothing," is coherent but differs from the Īqāẓ and Ḥikam ending, "nothing distracts you from Him." The parallel clarifies agency without establishing the transmission history of either ending.

11. Cairo I:346 — Sweeping the place of worship

Passage: 3:33–37 · The chosen households and Mary's consecration (English p. 533). **Finding:** Earlier source supports sweeping; Baḥr consonants unresolved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The service narrative concerns sweeping. Al-Baghawī's parallel at Q3:35 reads ويكنسها, whereas Cairo prints وينكسها, apparently transposing two consonants. The parallel supports "sweep"; an independent Baḥr witness would be needed to establish the authorial lettering.

12. Cairo I:385 — Sakanī: a dwelling or the beloved in whom one rests

Passage: 3:98–99 · Concealing the way of God and denying the presence of spiritual distinction (English p. 613). **Finding:** Lexical meaning plausible; poetic authorship unproved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Sakan can denote a beloved in whom one finds repose, as in Ibn Fāris and Ibn Manẓūr; this fits the poem's repeated language of the Beloved. Its attribution to al-Ḥallāj is disputed. Al-Shībī notes that a recitation from al-Ḥallāj need not establish composition by him and assembles his seven-line sequence from several recensions. The anonymous passage in Ibn ʿArabī supplies an earlier literary parallel. Neither anonymous transmission nor a composite modern edition conclusively settles authorship; the reported manuscript evidence requires direct comparison.

13. Cairo I:405 — Balāgh: bringing the hearer to the goal

Passage: 3:126–129 · Victory from God, the limit of Prophetic control and the stations of effacement and subsistence (English p. 651). **Finding:** Local meaning and analogy clarified; authorship of saying unproved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Balāgh may mean reaching an end or conveying a message. The disciple sets means in motion, God opens the door, and the teacher gives a reminder; successful attainment fits this local contrast. The travel idiom quoted by Ibn al-Jawzī, "Walking is my part; bringing me there is God's," provides a close linguistic parallel. The subsequent al-Qushayrī quotation begins later. Neither that quotation nor Ibn al-Jawzī's anecdote establishes the literary source of Ibn ʿAjība's clause.

14. Cairo I:408 — Obedience as the means; pardon and Paradise as the aims

Passage: 3:130–134 · Usury, generosity, forbearance, forgiveness and the station of iḥsān (English p. 655). **Finding:** Means/aims distinction clarified; nested report remains unverified. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Bi-ṭāʿatihi indicates the means, obedience, while ilā al-ʿillatayn points to the two desired benefits. Rūzbihān contrasts these benefits with the elect's summons to God and then observes the self's portion in seeking forgiveness. This explains the play between ailments and motives. The nested exchange about angels occurs in the cited source, but its modern note refers back to Ibn ʿAjība and supplies no earlier chain; the report's authentication remains separate from the lexical interpretation.

15. Cairo I:408 — Al-Ḥasan's sun, wind and rain comparison

Passage: 3:130–134 · Usury, generosity, forbearance, forgiveness and the station of iḥsān (English p. 655). **Finding:** Earlier quotation differs substantively; no independent Baḥr evidence. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Thaʿlabī's source passage gives a positive comparison with the universality of sun, wind and rain. Cairo instead gives a negative comparison and a gloss about favouring one land over another. That gloss makes Cairo's construction intelligible. The difference is substantive; its origin as an authorial alteration or a change in transmission cannot be determined from the source parallel alone.

16. Cairo I:410 — The tiny amount sucked from a date stone

Passage: 3:135–136 · Repentance, persistence in sin and eight named fruits of spiritual witnessing (English p. 661). **Finding:** Source maṣṣ noted against Cairo faṣṣ; unresolved Baḥr reading. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Sāḥilī's Bughyat al-sālik, p. 258, reads maṣṣ nawāt, "sucking a date-stone," in the discussion of what remains to be purified in the self. Al-Qushayrī's earlier Risāla puts a comparable question to al-Junayd and follows it with the manumission analogy. In each, a tiny unpaid remainder defeats a claim of freedom, illuminating the image of minimal worldly attachment. Cairo reads faṣṣ. A separate electronic Bughya apparatus reports omission of maṣṣ in witness B; that apparatus is absent from the 2019 edition, and B has not been examined in facsimile.

17. Cairo I:442 — Bi-llāh in the poem about hoarded wealth

Passage: 3:179 · Trial as disclosure: hidden sincerity and the unseen (English p. 721). **Finding:** Oath interpretation plausible; verse provenance uncertain. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The bi-llāh and wa-llāh parallels support an oath or adjuration in the rhetorical address. The preceding kam tuḍarru bihi concerns the extent of harm, not its duration. The following question about carrying wealth into death reinforces the rebuke. The parallels differ in wording and attribution and do not establish the authorship of Cairo's anonymous version or a unique grammatical account of its bi-llāh.

18. Cairo I:451 — The subject of wa-wāṣala al-kullu

Passage: 3:191–194 · Remembrance, contemplation and the passage from intellectual signs to witnessing (English p. 737). **Finding:** New electronic case-ending divergence logged; no independent manuscript reading. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Cairo vocalizes al-kullu in the nominative, as the subject of wāṣala, with maʿnāka as its object. Īqāẓ al-himam and Ibn ʿAbbād's Ghayth al-mawāhib place the poem within the disappearance of awareness of a separate rememberer; Ibn al-Bannā explicitly excludes indwelling or identity. The five-line anonymous Qaṣd al-mujarrad version corroborates the difficult line and broadens its remembrance and meeting context. These sources do not identify a unique referent for "the whole," the antecedent of "its meaning," or the exact force of min. The two-line Risāla and Sulamī parallels omit this third line.

19. Cairo I:460 — Darkness of the lights of Lordship

Passage: Not automatically located (English p. 751). **Finding:** Paradoxical phrase retained; exact meaning unsettled. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Cairo prints the unusual phrase "darkness of the lights of Lordship." The passage contrasts the effacement and witnessing associated with the end of Āl ʿImrān with the servanthood and subsistence at the opening of al-Nisāʾ. In Īqāẓ al-himam, language of darkening can accompany divine illumination and the eclipse of separate awareness. This is a contextual analogy, not an exact gloss of the present iḍāfa. The attribution of the borrowed definition to al-Qushayrī and the precise meaning of this phrase remain unresolved; no alternative letters are independently attested.

20. Cairo I:477 — Mother and grandmother in the maternal-sibling exclusion

Passage: Not automatically located (English p. 782). **Finding:** Legal qualification recognized; possible transmission omission. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Bayḍāwī transmits the father and grandfather terms as a prima facie implication and qualifies that implication by consensus. Cairo lacks the qualification. Mālik independently supplies the operative inheritance rule. The kinship nouns therefore have a coherent source context; the absence of the qualification is a separate transmission question.

21. Cairo I:482 — Seeing another man's wife or animal

Passage: Not automatically located (English p. 795). **Finding:** Printed disturbing analogy retained; precise point unclear. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The surrounding argument joins effective discipline of the self to a valid bond with a qualified shaykh. Cairo's final analogy says "seeing another's wife or animal," which does not transparently express that relation. "Inherit," "possess" and "train"

are conjectures without an independently attested variant. Rūzbihān's following quotation begins at "live with them honourably" and contains none of this preceding analogy, so it cannot determine the disputed verb. The precise sense remains unresolved.

22. Cairo I:504 — Seeking His pleasure in ostentatious expenditure

Passage: 4:37–39 · Miserliness, ostentation, and sincerity (English p. 840). **Finding:** Earlier-source corrections identified; Baḥr wording unestablished. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Bayḍāwī and Abū al-Suʿūd explicitly connect seeking God's pleasure with the purpose that faith would produce. This supports the supplied connective "[so as to]" and the divine pronoun. Cairo lacks that connective. On the same page Cairo attributes taqlīl, "diminution," to al-Bayḍāwī, whose text instead has taʿlīl, "giving the reason," referring to unbelief as the reason for ostentation. Both discrepancies concern textual transmission as well as interpretation.

23. Cairo I:506 — Asarra versus aṣarra in the inner-sins passage

Passage: 4:41–42 · Witnesses at the Resurrection (English p. 845). **Finding:** Printed asarra retained; aṣarra is conjectural. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Cairo prints asarra with sīn. Concealment suits the general subject of hidden heart sins, but asarra ʿalayhi is less straightforward than the familiar constructions with bi or ilā. Aṣarra ʿalayhi, "persisted in it," has a natural construction and close contextual parallels: persistence in major sins at I:135, the gloss of lam yuṣirrū at I:409, and persistence in heart diseases at I:550. None is a witness to the actual I:506 sentence. The local verb and its preposition remain unresolved.

24. Cairo I:516 — The poet's wish: his merit and their envy

Passage: 4:54–57 · Envy, divine favour, fire, and the shelter of contentment (English p. 865). **Finding:** Wish/optative sense supported; poem attribution still open. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The past-form verbs express a wish or imprecation. Al-Fārisī assigns continued merit to the speaker and envy to his opponents. Al-Marzūqī takes "the greater number of us" as the many enviers opposed to one man; "the one most enraged" remains another grammatical construal. The following line continues the opponents' inability to dislodge the speaker from their hostile thoughts. The anonymous source witness does not establish an author for the poem.

25. Cairo I:519 — The exception in the allegiance report

Passage: 4:59 · Obedience, juristic reasoning, and the authority of the shaykh (English p. 871). **Finding:** Authorial quotation differs from al-Bukhārī; transmission point unresolved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The report in al-Bukhārī expressly reads illā an, “unless,” while Cairo lacks its initial alif and has lā an. The cited saying therefore supports the exception in the English. The source parallel establishes its meaning; it does not determine when the letter disappeared from the Baḥr’s transmission.

26. Cairo I:519 — Questioner named Abū Wāʾil in the obedience report

Passage: 4:59 · Obedience, juristic reasoning, and the authority of the shaykh (English p. 871). **Finding:** Questioner’s identity differs from parallel; route unresolved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Muslim identifies the questioner and the speaker of the reply. Al-Thaʿlabī’s close parallel has ʿAlqama reporting from his father that an unnamed man asked, a form compatible with Muslim. Cairo’s Abū Wāʾil may reflect confusion between a narrator and the questioner, but the exact step at which that name entered the Baḥr remains unknown.

27. Cairo I:522 — The two objects of cognitive wajada

Passage: 4:60–63 · Appeal to false judgment, repentance, and private admonition (English p. 875). **Finding:** Grammatical account clarified; exact Cairo defect unresolved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: With cognitive wajada, “find or know,” Allāh is the first object and the predication about Him is the second complement. Tawwāban and raḥīman cannot alone be the two objects with Allāh ignored. With wajada in the sense of encountering, Allāh is the object and the adjectives admit circumstantial or substitutive analysis. The source analyses establish this contrast; Cairo’s defective formula does not permit an exact reconstruction of the authorial wording.

28. Cairo I:550 — Q4:99 ending in the exposition versus the primary verse block

Passage: 4:97–99 · The oppressed and emigration (English p. 927). **Finding:** Qurʾānic citation error identified in exposition; verse panel correct. **Disposition:** Keep the canonical verse panel; label the differing exposition a citation discrepancy, not a qirāʾa.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The Q4:99 verse block at Cairo I:549 ends ʿafuwwan ghafūran, “Pardoning, Forgiving.” The exposition at I:550 instead quotes ghafūran raḥīman, “Forgiving, Merciful,” which also ends the following Q4:100 verse block. This is a discrepancy in the exposition, not an established variant reading of Q4:99. Anticipation of the following verse is possible but unproved.

29. Cairo I:562 — Mulābasa and the smoothness explanation of marīd

Passage: 4:117–121 · False objects of devotion and Satan's promises (English p. 948). **Finding:** Earlier source supports malāsa; Cairo mulābasa retained. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Abū al-Suʿūd explicitly reads malāsa, "smoothness," beside the examples of a smooth palace, a beardless youth and a bare tree. Cairo and the electronic al-Bayḍāwī text have mulābasa, "association or intermingling," which does not explain those examples. "[Smoothness]" is supported by the lexical context and source parallel; the authorial Baḥr word remains unestablished.

30. Cairo I:569 — Scope of equality in the house

Passage: 4:129 · Equity between wives and human limitation (English p. 960). **Finding:** Outward legal duties verified; anomalous bayt clause retained. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Bayt can mean spending the night, as a verbal noun of bāta, and the following division of turns among wives makes that sense plausible. The negative with faqaṭ remains ambiguous. It may negate a restriction to nights; an assertion that only overnight equality is obligatory would require an additional textual assumption. The distinctions between unattainable perfect equality, attainable outward justice and inward affection do not determine the scope of the disputed clause. No independent variant or complete explanatory parallel establishes a unique reading.

31. Cairo I:577 — The lightened an clause and active/passive readings

Passage: 4:140–141 · The company one keeps (English p. 972). **Finding:** Source reading analysis clarified; Cairo text still suspect. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Bayḍāwī distinguishes ʿĀṣim's active nazzala from the passive reading of the others. In the passive analysis, an is lightened, with a suppressed pronoun of circumstance, and its clause stands as the passive subject. An is not negative in this verse. Cairo's nāfiya/fāʿil formula and active heading are distinct difficulties or an unmarked shift between readings. Nāʾiba fāʿil is a plausible reconstruction of the formula, but it is not independently attested Baḥr wording.

32. Cairo I:587 — Rīsh in the narrative of Jesus' ascent

Passage: 4:155–158 · Covenant, transgression, and the Messiah (English p. 987). **Finding:** Metaphor and source frame clarified; chain not authenticated. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Thaʿlabī's paragraph places the clothing and angelic transformation within the report attributed to Qatāda. The association with angels circling the Throne supports "feathers" for rīsh, although "fine apparel" remains a lexical alternative. Dhukira lanā denotes an unspecified report to Qatāda, and the passage supplies no complete chain sufficient to establish historical authenticity.

33. Cairo I:598 — What the illustrative ruler does to tyrants

Passage: 4:172–173 · Servanthood, angels, and its four marks (English p. 1006). **Finding:** Meaning intentionally left indeterminate; source verb differs. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Zamakhsharī uses a ruler's contrasted treatment to explain the distribution of recompense between two groups. His punitive verb, nakkala, differs from Cairo's qaṭʿ and does not specify the latter's physical or political act. "Cut off" therefore retains the expression's indeterminacy; killing, mutilation and dismissal cannot be inferred from this illustrative phrase alone.

34. Cairo I:600 — A full sister with a paternal half-sister

Passage: Not automatically located (English p. 1011). **Finding:** Operative legal case clear; kinship wording defective. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The next words expressly allocate a sixth to the paternal half-sister, so the preceding "full sister with the father" is defective in context. Mālik confirms the case: a sole full sister receives half and the paternal sister or sisters the complementary sixth; a father's presence excludes siblings elsewhere. The legal case is clear, while the exact missing kinship wording in the Baḥr remains a textual question.

35. Cairo I:601 — Paternal siblings and the priority of full siblings

Passage: Not automatically located (English p. 1011). **Finding:** Mālikī inheritance outcome clear; min/maʿa text unresolved. **Disposition:** Preserve printed Arabic and XVI English; place explanatory evidence in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The preceding case includes a male full sibling. Mālik expressly excludes paternal siblings in that situation while distinguishing cases with only full sisters. The exclusion therefore belongs to the specified case, not to every case involving a full sister. Cairo's min remains unusual; maʿa is a conjectural replacement of the preposition rather than an independently attested reading.

36. Cairo I:312 — The verse-placement instruction at Q2:281

Passage: 2:280–281 · Respite for the debtor and the final return (English p. 471). **Finding:** Verse-placement interpretation established; chronology disputed. **Disposition:** Preserve the already-adopted XVI translation; expand evidence and limits in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: The placement expression denotes the boundary after the preceding two hundred and eighty verses. Al-Qārī, Jamʿ al-wasāʾil I:14, quotes al-Ṭībī's gloss of raʾs al-āya as the end of a verse. Al-Qurṭubī III:341–342 and al-Bursawī on Q2:281 place this verse between the usury and debt passages; Aṭfayyish explicitly numbers it 281. This clarifies the placement language without establishing the report's revelation chronology or the interval before the Prophet's death.

37. Cairo I:217 — The scope of the al-Tawshīḥ abridgment

Passage: 2:187 · The nights of fasting, the dawn's discernment and retreat (English p. 297). **Finding:** Quotation arrangement clarified; independent chain analysis distinct. **Disposition:** Preserve the already-adopted XVI translation; expand evidence and limits in critical apparatus.

Earlier dossier, abridged: Al-Suyūṭī's al-Tawshīḥ, p. 1427, on al-Bukhārī 1916–1917, distinguishes ʿAdī's later experience from Sahl's account of the earlier men. His comment on narrators' wording concerns ʿAdī's "when it was revealed." Cairo's abridgment instead attaches that comment to "then God revealed 'of dawn'." Al-Suyūṭī does not draw Ibn ʿAjība's subsequent inference in this passage. The source comparison does not determine whether the discrepancy arose with Ibn ʿAjība, an intermediary or later transmission.

6. Translation and reader-quality control

The full passage range is intact. The prefatory and al-Fātiḥa material is present before al-Baqara: English pages 4–42 contain the author's preface, the ten names of al-Fātiḥa, textual and legal discussion of basmala, grammatical analysis, sūrah commentary, inward exegesis and Āmīn. The introduction to al-Baqara begins at p.43. Ibn ʿAjība's other, larger Fātiḥa commentary with ten introductions is a separate work and not a missing chapter in al-Baḥr.

Technical terms remain transliterated where the author's distinctions depend on them. The high-risk pairs that especially warrant human specialist scrutiny include sharīʿa/ḥaqīqa, fanāʾ/baqāʾ, farq/jamʿ, ḥikma/qudra, dhawq/maʿrifa, nafs/rūḥ/sirr, the Mālikī inheritance cases, and the Arabic syntactic cruxes in this dossier. Current translations are not altered merely to make a difficulty disappear.

The original indexes, Cairo editorial notes, report-source register and translator's source notes were preserved in their pre-existing form. No new global claim is made to have independently authenticated every report or poem.

7. Editorial work remaining without needing new manuscripts, but requiring an external person or physical equipment

Independent specialist scrutiny: A qualified Arabic textual critic should evaluate the Arabic and conjectural emendations; a scholar familiar with Ibn ʿAjība's Sufi terminology should check the spiritual allusions; and an informed Mālikī law / Qurʾānic readings reviewer should inspect the legal and qirāʾāt passages. A reviewer can mark "retain," "revise English," "note only," or "unresolved," with reasons and signed disclosure. No external human review has been performed or purported here.

Print: Full original English pagination is fixed at 1–1,306, and no inherited indices are silently repaginated. For binding proofs, separate the reader into (A) English pp. 1–487 (preface/al-Fātiḥa/al-Baqara); (B) pp. 488–1014 (Āl ʿImrān/al-Nisāʾ); (C) pp. 1015–1306 (indexes, notes and source reference matter). The new XVIII critical supplement follows the reference fascicle in the digitally combined edition. A digital visual/structural preflight can be performed, but physical paper, ink, margins and binding durability have not been tested. Some cross-fascicle PDF links may no longer resolve within extracted print fascicles; use the combined digital PDF for links.

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8. What additional manuscripts alone could decide

Obtain images showing independent scripts, corrections, marginalia, dated colophons and folios; describe them before assuming genealogical independence; compare all relevant readings (not only seven prominent cruxes), assess shared mistakes and editorial interventions; report both selected and rejected readings. Until that work is done, these questions remain textually open. This does not prevent scholarly use of the complete English translation with transparently stated copytext limitations.

Edition-change ledger: 37 existing dossiers structurally registered; six direct-source refinements consolidated; bibliographic witness claims downgraded when pages were unavailable; fresh PDF link and range audit performed. **Authorial translation rewrites: 0. Arabic textual emendations: 0. Manuscript readings invented: 0.**